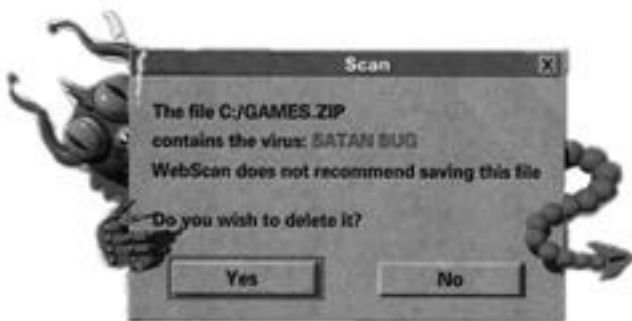


example, the anti-virus software can flag this suspicious behaviour, alert the user and confirm an action. Unlike the dictionary approach, the suspicious behaviour approach can provide protection against brand-new viruses that do not exist in any virus dictionaries. On the flip side, it also cries wolf a number of times, which leads to the user being desensitised to all warnings. This problem has worsened over the last few years as a number of non-malicious programs were made to modify other .exe files without regard to this false positive issue. This has led to most anti-virus programs focusing on the dictionary definition approach.

A number of software vendors specialise in anti-virus software. All of them also tackle other intrusions such as Trojans and



**Viruses are getting deadlier and difficult to tackle.**

worms. Though a few anti-virus software are resource-hungry, these programs are increasingly being made to consume fewer resources. Some of the more widely-used anti-virus software are McAfee, Norton, AVG and Avast.

The easiest way to protect your computer is to take precautionary measures such as not downloading suspicious attachments without a virus scan. Also, it is advisable to not download software and other .exe files from suspicious Web sites.